05 | RESPECTFUL REVERSAL | RESOURCE

Respectful Reversal: Leading Through a Change

How to change direction while keeping roles and responsibilities clear

New facts sometimes mean a decision has to change. Handled well, the conversation helps people understand why and get back to work with confidence. Use these steps when you change direction within your authority or explain a change someone else approved.

01	**Recognize** Say what was decided and what was known at the time. Acknowledge the reasoning behind it. Check the facts before you call the decision authorized or reasonable.
02	**Explain** Describe what's new: the information, service risk, or limit that means the decision has to change. Talk about the work, not the person.
03	**Own** Own your part in the first direction and the new one. Don't pin it on staff, and don't pass along a change without explaining it.
04	**Direct** Lay out what happens next, when, who does it, and what help is available. Flag any decision that still needs someone with authority.
05	**Clarify** Make clear whether the change is for this situation only or for a wider process. A one-time fix isn't a new rule.

If you're receiving the change

Ask about anything that wasn't covered. Say back what you'll do, what you can still decide, and who will help. When you pass the change on, keep the meaning the same and leave blame out of it.

> **Respect and accountability go together**
> Being respectful doesn't mean skipping a required review. It means keeping the facts, expectations, help, and responsibilities clear while the work gets fixed.

Based on: Safe to Decide training, Supervisor edition, slides 23–25.

05 | RESPECTFUL REVERSAL | RESOURCE (CONTINUED)

Respectful Reversal: Example and Planning

Example only: a confirmed coverage gap means today's assignments change for one day.

Step	Try saying
1. Recognize	"You planned today around the coverage schedule we confirmed."
2. Explain	"We've got a coverage gap in the afternoon service window, so today's assignments need to change."
3. Own	"It's on me to make the new plan clear and help the team make it work."
4. Direct	"This afternoon, please follow the revised assignment. I'll help get the word out and line up support before the window opens."
5. Clarify	"This is just for today. Tomorrow's schedule and the normal approval process aren't changing."

Plan the conversation

Use this space	Your notes
First decision and facts	
What's new, and why	
My part	
Next step and help	
One time or new rule?	

Did it land?

Ask: "What's your next step, and what help do you still need?" Then settle who will tell anyone else affected and whether a written CCE message or an updated document is needed.

Based on: Safe to Decide training, Supervisor edition, slides 23–25.